

- **Response to AI Feedback 20261003**

- *Re. Eye of God*

Eye of god.

“Artefact. A gem which renders powerless all magic in the area, and annihilates SPECTRES and ZOMBIES. Having taken it up, you must keep it, otherwise you will be CURSED.”

“Priests, witches, scholar, apprentice and wizards, and all other artefacts are powerless **when this gem is in the same area** (priests, witches, scholar, apprentice and wizards retain fighting strength); spectres and zombies are permanently destroyed. The statue bearing the lost ruby is powerless to attack. Once a party has taken up the Eye, the gem must be kept with the main body of the party; otherwise there is a curse on that party until the gem is again taken up by the same or another party. This applies even if the gem is left behind involuntarily, e.g. on the body of a slain creature.

Note that on encountering the Eye your party is under no obligation to pick it up.”

I think the interpretation that it *does not need to be borne* is reinforced by contrasting this wording with the wording used in relation to Talisman:

Talisman. 10 vp.

“Artefact. Wards off ZOMBIES and GHOULS from the party displaying it. On the fourth level or deeper, also wards off SPECTRES.”

“**It has no warding-off power until actually taken up** by an exploring party; i.e. it may be guarded by ghouls or spectres. When warded off, ghouls and spectres cease to have any effect as long as the party with the talisman remains in the area. The party possessing it may use its power to protect other parties in the same area.”

- **(Also in Options and Variations – Hidden Cards):**

“Players need keep on display in their parties only their creature cards and any artefact which is being used. (It is wise to **keep the talisman on display** so that ghouls and spectres can be passed by without comment.)”

Talisman explicitly does not work unless being borne by a creature. So Mr. Donnelly could easily have included that phrasing for Eye of God if it was appropriate. I conclude that the Eye of God is “always on” affecting the area it is currently in.

- **Counter Argument:**

Interestingly however, if you were to apply D&D lore in this situation the answer would be the exact opposite in both cases!

A talisman does not need to be displayed for its deterrent to have effect, which is radiated effect. It can be safely tucked into a shirt. The Eye is a magical gem. In D&D, such gems almost always need to be displayed

in some way, or some action taken (such as shattering it to release the entity trapped inside...) in order to activate the magic.

But that's a different rule system...

- *Re: Thief*

Ah very interesting...

I made an error in the Default Loadout – but not for the reason Claude thinks.....!

This highlights a more general issue with the rules as written in the booklets and on the cards.

Mr. Donnelly had to deal with the fact that the base game was already in existence when the extension came out. So, Magic Sword and Magic Axe have text on them from the base set – and that was decided before there was such a thing as a Thief.

So the game cannot make the decision as to who can use which artefact based only on the artefact card text. It must also consider the creature card text. (In this case Thief: “Uses artefacts as a Man”)

i.e.: If a Man can use the Sword, Axe, or Shield, then a Thief can too.

Same goes for (Witch: “Uses artefacts as a Priest”).

and (Scholar: “Uses artefacts as a Priest”).

and (Apprentice: “Uses artefacts as a Wizard”).

We may (?) also have a related problem with Woman Hero, because her card text does not read “*uses artefacts as a Hero*”. Instead the booklet rules text reads “*The woman-hero has all the capabilities of a woman and a hero.*”

So I suspect there may be a systemic bug due not implementing “*uses artefacts as*” and “*has all the capabilities of*” correctly.

Now to my error – given that Thief and Woman have identical fighting strength and can use the same artefacts, the only reason to rank one higher in preference for artefact loadout is other abilities. The Thief's special ability is of no use to strangers. The Woman's special ability is:

Unicorn. STR 4. CAP 0 kg. 4 vp.

“Friendly to WOMEN, otherwise indifferent.”

If found with a woman, it will remain loyal to her.

I interpret the Unicorn rules as meaning:

IF (a stranger party is approached and the outcome is “hostile”) AND (The stranger party includes a Woman) AND (The stranger party includes a Unicorn) THEN (The Unicorn will fight for the stranger party.)

So the Woman's special ability is useful.

I have changed the preference lists to place Woman higher than Thief.

- ***Re. Sorcerer***

Now having said all that above, Mr. Donnelly *did not* include “uses artefacts as a Wizard” for the Sorcerer card text - and did not include it in the booklet text either !!

However, I'm going to argue quite strongly that there is an omission in the rules as-written, and in fact Sorcerer can use the same artefacts as a Wizard. I'm not necessarily suggesting that the Apprentice and the Sorcerer are actually a type of Wizard, only that they have access to same usable artefacts - because their magical power is basically of the same type as that a Wizard uses, only stronger (in that it can resist Eye of God to some extent.)

My reasoning is twofold:

1. The Apprentice **uses artefacts as a Wizard**. Are we really saying that the Apprentice can use a Magical Staff or bear The Ring, but the Sorcerer cannot - for some unidentified reason?
2. The Sorcerer is the most powerful magic user in the game. Is it even conceivable that he just never got around to figuring out that a simple 6 foot length of oak/ash/elm amplifies his magical power?

- ***Re: Definitions***

Well caught Claude! I used the terms and did not define them...

There was no need to introduce the term “weapon” to mean either Magical Sword or Magical Axe. I have updated the Default Loadout.

I have also updated the paragraph covering The Ring to define what is meant by “adjusted strength”.

- ***Re: Strengths***

I don't know where he is getting Hero STR 6 and Spectre STR 4.

I will send a latest copy of the Consolidated Rules just in case.....

- ***Re: Hero's strength decides The Ring***

We need to implement “uses artefacts as” and “has all the qualities of” correctly,

and also implement the **house rule** Sorcerer: Uses artefacts as a Wizard”.

Question for Mark: If Sorcerer uses artefacts as a Wizard is taken on board, should I update the Consolidated Rules, or just add it as an Addendum, making clear this was not in the original rules?